

Calabasas Confidential: Keeping up with the Kardashians

Thomas Jefferson Model United Nations Conference

TechMUN XXXIII



High School Specialized Committee

Co-Chairs: Christine Qiao and Michelle Zuo

Thomas Jefferson High School for Science and Technology

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Dear Delegates,

It is with immense pleasure that we welcome you all to TechMUN XXXIII and Calabasas Confidential: Keeping up with the Kardashians. We are both seniors at TJ and are elated to be working with all of you in this upcoming committee. We are excited for a weekend of debate on some of this committee's top issues: *Protecting Kardashian Brands* and *Kinder Kardashians Conquer TikTok*. Each of you will be representing a celebrity, and we hope to see those characters reflected through your solutions and speeches.

This weekend we are looking for delegates with innovative ideas and detailed solutions to present and hope that every one of you will have a strong presence in committee to ensure debate is constantly flowing. As co-chairs, we would like to see eloquent, substance-filled speeches, along with exceptional leadership, teamwork, and diplomacy. While the committee is a place of debate, it is of utmost importance to be considerate and respectful of other delegates. We hope that every one of you steps out of your comfort zone this weekend, whether it be through giving speeches without notepads or branching out more in unmods. Most importantly, don't give up at any point in committee, as one mess-up is not the end of the world and we as your chairs understand that committee can be nerve-wracking. Ultimately, we know how it feels to participate in committee for hours on end, so don't be afraid to make mistakes and try new things. Whether this is your first conference or you are a seasoned delegate, we hope to make this TechMUN as fun as possible. If you have any questions, don't hesitate to email kardashianstechmun2026@gmail.com.

Christine Qiao & Michelle Zuo

Co-Chairs, Keeping up with the Kardashians, 2025

Introduction to KUTWK

Keeping Up with the Kardashians (KUWTK) is an American reality television series that aired on E! from October 2007 to June 2021, running for 20 seasons across nearly fourteen years. Created by Ryan Seacrest and executive-produced alongside Kris Jenner, the series follows the personal and professional lives of the Kardashian-Jenner family. At its center is Kris Jenner and her children, Kourtney Kardashian, Kim Kardashian, Khloé Kardashian, Kendall Jenner, Kylie Jenner, and Rob Kardashian. The show also featured Caitlyn Jenner, along with close friends and business associates involved in the family's expanding ventures.

Initially framed as a behind-the-scenes look at the daily lives of a wealthy Los Angeles family, the series evolved into one of the most influential reality programs of the twenty-first century. Debuting during a pivotal shift in celebrity culture, KUWTK demonstrated how reality television could shape public image, amplify media presence, and cultivate consumer loyalty. Audiences observed the family navigate relationships, public controversies, and entrepreneurial ventures while steadily expanding their influence across fashion, beauty, and digital media.

Throughout its run, the series functioned as a powerful engine for visibility and brand development. Personal milestones and conflicts generated sustained media attention, which translated into commercial growth and long-term cultural relevance. By the time the show concluded in 2021, the Kardashian-Jenner family had established a global, multi-billion-dollar enterprise. The franchise continues with *The Kardashians*, which premiered on Hulu in 2022, reflecting the family's enduring presence within contemporary media and business landscapes.

Topic A: Protecting Kardashian Brands

Background:

Over the course of *Keeping Up with the Kardashians* and the years that followed, the Kardashian-Jenner family converted television visibility into an expansive portfolio of consumer brands. Kim Kardashian founded SKIMS in 2019, a shapewear and loungewear company that reached a valuation of \$4 billion by 2023, positioning it among the fastest-growing fashion brands of the decade. Khloé Kardashian co-founded Good American in 2016 with Emma Grede, establishing a size-inclusive denim and apparel company that gained recognition within the body-positive fashion movement. In 2015, Kylie Jenner launched Kylie Cosmetics, beginning with a single lip kit marketed directly to her social media audience. The brand's rapid growth culminated in the 2019 sale of a 51 percent stake to Coty Inc. for a reported \$600 million. Kim Kardashian also introduced KKW Beauty in 2017, later rebranding her beauty ventures under SKKN by Kim as the company expanded into skincare.

Across these ventures, close collaborators such as Emma Grede and Jonathan Cheban have contributed to product development, marketing strategy, and brand positioning. A consistent pattern links these enterprises: each draws heavily on the founder's personal celebrity, relies on direct-to-consumer sales amplified through social media, and operates within industries shaped by beauty standards, body image, and aspirational lifestyle branding. The reality television platform cultivated a loyal audience whose sustained engagement translated into measurable purchasing behavior and brand loyalty.

Current Situation:

The Kardashian brands now operate within a volatile commercial and cultural environment. Their close association with individual celebrity identities creates structural vulnerability. Public

backlash surrounding personal relationships, controversial statements, or accusations of cultural insensitivity can rapidly affect product perception and sales. SKIMS has faced scrutiny regarding shade inclusivity and labor transparency, while Kylie Cosmetics encountered early quality control criticisms that challenged consumer trust during a pivotal growth period.

Intellectual property disputes present an additional layer of complexity. High-profile naming controversies have demonstrated how branding decisions can generate cultural backlash. In 2019, Kim Kardashian's attempt to trademark the term "Kimono" for her shapewear line drew widespread criticism and ultimately led to a rebrand under the SKIMS name. The episode highlighted the importance of cultural awareness in global trademark strategy and illustrated how legal initiatives may carry reputational consequences.

Social media remains both an asset and a risk factor. Platforms such as Instagram, TikTok, and YouTube continue to serve as primary marketing channels, yet they also accelerate the spread of criticism. With hundreds of millions of followers across accounts, even minor controversies gain immediate amplification. Consumer watchdog accounts, investigative journalists, and competing influencers actively scrutinize product claims, ethical sourcing practices, and marketing tactics. The rise of "de-influencing" trends, in which creators discourage audiences from purchasing highly promoted products, reflects a broader shift in consumer skepticism toward celebrity-endorsed brands.

Possible Solutions:

A long-term approach to strengthening these brands involves reducing reliance on a single celebrity figure and building a more independent, institution-based identity. This can include expanding partnerships with established retailers and organizations, highlighting

leadership beyond the founding celebrity, and emphasizing product quality and brand values rather than personality alone. Increasing transparency through clearer sustainability goals, third-party oversight, and inclusive practices can further build consumer trust in industries that face high public scrutiny. Diversifying revenue streams beyond social media driven sales, such as through retail expansion, licensing, and international growth, can also provide greater stability. Together, these broad strategies offer starting points for developing brands that are more resilient to controversy, shifting consumer expectations, and changes in the digital media landscape.

Questions to Consider:

1. To what extent should celebrity-founded brands be held accountable for the personal conduct of their founders when assessing commercial legitimacy and ethical responsibility?
2. How can intellectual property protections balance aggressive brand defense with cultural sensitivity in an increasingly globalized market?
3. Should social media platforms bear greater responsibility for moderating counterfeit promotion and misinformation targeting high-profile consumer brands?

Helpful Links:

- https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Keeping_Up_with_the_Kardashians.
- https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Kim_Kardashian.
- https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Kylie_Jenner.
- https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Khlo%C3%A9_Kardashian
- <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Skims>
- https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Kylie_Cosmetics

Topic B: Kinder Kardashians Conquer TikTok

Background:

The Kardashian-Jenner children reflect a new phase of celebrity culture. They are among the first generation born into constant online visibility, and they are now old enough for their personalities to shape public-facing content. North West, born in 2013 to Kim Kardashian and Kanye West, is the clearest example. She appears frequently in short-form videos and has become a central reason audiences engage with Kim's TikTok content. Her posts and appearances include rap performances, art and sketches, and casual family moments that routinely generate major view counts and media attention. Stormi Webster, born in 2018 to Kylie Jenner and Travis Scott, has also developed a strong online following through regular appearances in Kylie's content, with fan engagement that often treats her as a celebrity in her own right. Mason Disick, Kourtney Kardashian's eldest child, drew headlines after briefly going live on Instagram at age ten, prompting immediate concern and a swift shutdown by his family.

TikTok has become the main venue for this generational shift in influence. The platform rewards quick, informal content that feels spontaneous and personal. Children often fit that style naturally, which increases both engagement and exposure. At the same time, TikTok's algorithm can rapidly push content to massive audiences, and that scale creates elevated risks for minors. The Kardashian children appear across a spectrum of supervision, from tightly managed cameos on a parent's account to less controllable circulation through fan pages and repost accounts that distribute clips without consent or context.

This topic sits within a larger child influencer economy that continues to grow. Children appear across toy content, family vlogs, gaming, lifestyle, and fashion, with many accounts

generating revenue through ads, sponsorships, or broader brand promotion. Platforms have struggled to regulate this space consistently, and high-profile celebrity families draw attention to unresolved questions about privacy, labor, and the ethics of building engagement around minors.

Current Situation:

The Kardashian children's online presence is shaped by parental control, platform rules, uneven legal protections, and intense public scrutiny. TikTok's terms require users to be at least 13 to create an account, and accounts associated with younger users face tighter messaging limits. North West, who turned eleven in 2024, appears largely through supervised access on Kim Kardashian's account. Over time, the content has increasingly centered on North's creative voice, which has blurred the line between a parent posting family moments and a child functioning as the primary on-screen draw for a monetized platform. That ambiguity raises practical questions about consent, decision-making power, and who benefits from the attention and revenue.

A major concern is the lack of comprehensive federal child labor protections for social media content creation in the United States. Traditional child labor laws were designed for physical workplaces and do not map cleanly onto digital content, even when the content generates significant income. Existing entertainment protections such as the Coogan Law were built around child actors and studio structures. Social media complicates enforcement because parents control the accounts, the production environment is private, and compensation may be indirect through brand value, affiliate links, or business growth rather than clear paychecks. Some states have moved toward updating rules for child content creators, but coverage and enforcement remain inconsistent.

Privacy risks are equally serious. These children's faces, voices, homes, routines, and milestones are widely circulated at a scale they cannot meaningfully control. Fan communities amplify this exposure by reposting clips, compiling content, and speculating about their lives. In some cases, commentary turns harsh or intrusive, and criticism directed at a child often stems from decisions made by adults managing the account. Child development and family law experts increasingly warn about the long-term impact of growing up with constant public evaluation and a permanent digital footprint.

Possible Solutions:

There are several broad approaches that could address the challenges surrounding the Kardashian children's expanding presence on TikTok and similar platforms. Legal modernization represents one avenue, as updating child labor and earnings protection laws to explicitly cover monetized social media participation would clarify compensation, consent, and long-term financial safeguards. Platform-level reforms could also play a role, including stronger age verification, clearer disclosure requirements for monetized accounts featuring minors, and improved tools for limiting unauthorized reposts or excessive algorithmic amplification. At the family level, establishing transparent boundaries between personal sharing and brand-driven content, implementing structured supervision, and developing long-term digital strategies centered on child well-being may reduce both reputational and psychological risks. Finally, broader cultural advocacy and evolving industry standards around digital child privacy could help reshape expectations for how minors are represented online, balancing opportunity with sustained protection as the media landscape continues to shift.

Questions to Consider:

1. At what point does a child's frequent appearance in monetized social media content shift from family sharing to a form of digital labor requiring formal legal protection?
2. How should responsibility be divided between parents, platforms, and regulators in safeguarding minors who become central figures in high-visibility online content?
3. What long-term psychological, privacy, and identity implications might arise for children who grow up with millions of viewers observing and commenting on their lives?
4. When fan communities and repost accounts distribute content featuring celebrity children without consent or context, what mechanisms should exist to limit that circulation and who should be responsible for enforcement?

Helpful Links:

- https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Keeping_Up_with_the_Kardashians.
- https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Kim_Kardashian.
- https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Kylie_Jenner.
- https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Khlo%C3%A9_Kardashian
- <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/TikTok>
- https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Kardashian_family

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- "U.S. Sues TikTok for Significant Child Privacy Violations." *EPIC - Electronic Privacy Information Center*, 2024, epic.org/u-s-sues-tiktok-for-significant-child-privacy-violations/. Accessed 5 Feb. 2026.

Dossier:

Kris Jenner

Kris Jenner is the matriarch of the Kardashian-Jenner family and the primary architect of their media and business empire. She manages her children's careers and negotiates major brand deals. Her influence extends across reality television, fashion, and entertainment.

Caitlyn Jenner

Caitlyn Jenner is a former Olympic gold medalist in the decathlon and a public figure. She is the parent of Kendall and Kylie Jenner and was formerly married to Kris Jenner. Caitlyn has also been involved in politics and public speaking.

Kourtney Kardashian

Kourtney Kardashian is the eldest Kardashian sibling and a longtime reality television personality. She founded the lifestyle brand Poosh and women's health supplement brand Lemme. She is known for emphasizing wellness and privacy compared to her sisters.

Kim Kardashian

Kim Kardashian is a media personality, entrepreneur, and legal advocate. She founded SKIMS and has worked on criminal justice reform initiatives. Kim is one of the most recognizable figures in global pop culture.

Khloé Kardashian

Khloé Kardashian is a reality TV personality and businesswoman. She co-founded the fashion brand Good American. She is also known for openly discussing health, fitness, and body image.

Rob Kardashian

Rob Kardashian is the only brother in the Kardashian family. He founded the sock brand Arthur George. Rob appears less frequently in the media than his sisters.

Kendall Jenner

Kendall Jenner is an international fashion model who has worked with major luxury brands. She is also a co-founder of the tequila brand 818. Kendall is known for maintaining a lower-profile public image.

Kylie Jenner

Kylie Jenner is a beauty entrepreneur and social media figure. She founded Kylie Cosmetics, which rapidly grew into a global brand. Kylie is one of the most followed celebrities online.

Scott Disick

Scott Disick is a reality television personality and entrepreneur. He is Kourtney Kardashian's

former partner and the father of her children. Scott has worked in real estate and brand promotions.

Lamar Odom

Lamar Odom is a former professional NBA player. He won two championships with the Los Angeles Lakers. He was previously married to Khloé Kardashian.

Kanye West

Kanye West is a Grammy-winning rapper, producer, and fashion designer. He founded the Yeezy brand and significantly influenced modern music and fashion. Kanye was previously married to Kim Kardashian.

Tristan Thompson

Tristan Thompson is a professional NBA player. He is the father of Khloé Kardashian's children, True and Tatum. His personal life has frequently drawn media attention.

Travis Scott

Travis Scott is a rapper, producer, and performer. He has released multiple chart-topping albums and led major tours. He is the father of Kylie Jenner's children, Stormi and Aire.

Travis Barker

Travis Barker is the drummer for the band Blink-182. He is also a music producer and entrepreneur. Travis is married to Kourtney Kardashian.

Kris Humphries

Kris Humphries is a former NBA player. He was briefly married to Kim Kardashian in 2011. Their marriage received extensive media coverage.

Corey Gamble

Corey Gamble is a business executive and talent manager. He is Kris Jenner's longtime partner. Corey has worked in the entertainment industry for many years.

Blac Chyna

Blac Chyna is a model and entrepreneur. She shares a child with Rob Kardashian. She has launched beauty and lifestyle ventures independently.

Tyga

Tyga is a rapper and music artist. He previously dated Kylie Jenner. Tyga continues to release music and tour globally.

Jonathan Cheban (Foodgod)

Jonathan Cheban is a media personality and entrepreneur. He is a close friend of Kim Kardashian. He built the Foodgod brand around food and lifestyle content.

North West

North West is the daughter of Kim Kardashian and Kanye West. She has appeared in public performances and creative projects at a young age. Her presence has sparked discussions about child fame.

Penelope Disick

Penelope Disick is the daughter of Kourtney Kardashian and Scott Disick. She occasionally appears in family media content. She largely remains out of the public spotlight.

Jordyn Woods

Jordyn Woods is a model and social media influencer. She was formerly part of Kylie Jenner's inner circle. Jordyn later built her own brand and career after public controversy.

Sofia Richie

Sofia Richie is a fashion model and influencer. She previously dated Scott Disick. She is also the daughter of musician Lionel Richie.

Timothée Chalamet

Timothée Chalamet is an Academy Award-nominated actor. He is known for major film roles in both independent and blockbuster movies. He is currently dating Kylie Jenner.

Alabama Barker

Alabama Barker is the daughter of Travis Barker and the stepdaughter of Kourtney Kardashian. She is an aspiring musician and influencer. Alabama has developed her own social media presence.

Pete Davidson

Pete Davidson is a comedian and actor. He is best known for his work on *Saturday Night Live*. Pete previously dated Kim Kardashian.

Bad Bunny

Bad Bunny is a globally successful Puerto Rican musician. He has dominated streaming platforms and international charts. He was briefly linked to Kendall Jenner.

Hailey Bieber

Hailey Bieber is a model and entrepreneur. She is married to singer Justin Bieber. Hailey is a good friend of the Jenners and is linked to the fashion world.

Ray J

Ray J is a singer, actor, and entrepreneur. He previously dated Kim Kardashian. He has maintained a career in music and business.

Lewis Hamilton

Lewis Hamilton is a Formula 1 World Champion and currently racing for Ferrari. He has been linked to Kim Kardashian through recent rumored relationships and public appearances.

